

DESIGN CODE NS 09

NOVALITY STORE

Designed by Novality Crochet Studio



Shelby the Sea Turtle Bag Charm

A pocket sea turtle on a keyring – the classic market impulse buy. Under half an hour, a couple of grams of yarn, and the head and flippers are worked straight into the shell so there is almost nothing to sew.

30 minutes

Easy

~3 g of yarn

FINISHED SIZE

About 3.7 cm (1.5 in) across the flippers, 3.2 cm long and 1.9 cm deep. DK cotton on a 2.5 mm hook; shell and underside both finish at 24 stitches. A bigger 5.7 cm version is included.

Before You Begin

SAFETY - EYES & KEYRING

Two 4 mm safety eyes are small parts. At this size French knots are the better fit (see section 4). Not tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71; for children under 3 use French knots. The keyring is the other hazard: attach it through TWO stitches at the back of the shell and knot the yarn inside – a charm that comes off a bag is a small part with a metal ring.

Materials & gauge

- **Shell yarn** DK / light worsted (#3) cotton, about 1 g – sage, teal, mustard or rust.
- **Body yarn** DK cotton, about 1 g in contrast cream, sand or pale green.
- **Hook & eyes** 2.5 mm (US C-2). Two 4 mm safety eyes or two black French knots.
- **Also** a pinch of polyfill (under 1 g), tapestry needle, one 25 mm keyring or lobster clasp per turtle.
- **Gauge** about 3.5 mm per stitch and 3.2 mm per round. The whole charm is 203 stitches (~3 m of DK); 24 stitches = a 26.7 mm disc that sets the size.

Techniques

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 Magic ring & spiral | Start in a magic ring and work continuous spiral rounds with a marker – no joins, no chain 1 between rounds. |
| 2 Back loop only (BLO) | Work into the far loop only; the unused loops form a raised ridge. On the shell that ridge is the rim – it makes the dome read as a shell rather than a bun. |
| 3 Clusters into one stitch | The trick of the head and flippers: work every stitch of the group into ONE stitch of the previous round so they share an anchor and fan into a bump. Each cluster consumes one stitch and produces as many as it contains – so a 24-stitch round produces 35. |
| 4 Whip stitch & French knots | Join shell and underside with an even whip stitch so the seam does not pucker. Eyes: bring the needle up, wrap the floss once or twice around the needle, push back down close by and pull slowly. |

1. Shell - top (a shallow dome)

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	
R5	BLO sc around	(24)	rim ridge
R6	sc in each st around	(24)	FO, 30 cm tail

Before joining, embroider five or six shallow V shapes in a darker shade across the dome - two minutes, and the difference between a turtle and a green blob.

2. Underside - contrast flat disc

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	do NOT fasten off - work head & flippers next

3. Head & flippers - worked into Rnd 4

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R5	3 sc, (sc,hdc,hdc,sc) in next st, 4 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 3 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 4 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 3 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 2 sc	(35)	head & flippers

This consumes $3+1+4+1+3+1+4+1+3+1+2 = 24$ stitches (closing the disc) and produces 35. The first, four-stitch bump is the HEAD; the four smaller bumps are flippers. Sl st in the next stitch and FO with a 20 cm tail. The bumps land on stitches 4, 9, 13, 18 and 22, placing the front flippers either side of the head.

4. Face - read before you join

The head bump is only ~7-10 mm across, and a 4 mm safety-eye washer (6-7 mm) often will not fit inside it. Use two small black FRENCH KNOTS, 2 stitches apart, low on the head bump. If you do use safety eyes, place them 1 stitch apart and seat the washers BEFORE joining - once the shell is on you cannot reach inside.



The BLO rim ridge and embroidered V markings turn the dome into a shell.

5. Joining & finishing

Fix the eyes first. Hold the shell to the underside, wrong sides together, head pointing away from the shell's tail. Whip-stitch with the shell's 30 cm tail, matching 24 to 24 – NOT 24 to 35: the underside's outer round has 35 stitches but only 24 anchor positions (19 plain + 5 clusters). Put one shell stitch against each anchor; at a bump, pass through the BASE stitch the bump was worked into, not the bump itself. Add a small pinch of stuffing about three-quarters of the way round (keep it flat – the shell holds only ~8 cm³). Weave in ends. Attach the keyring through TWO stitches at the back, opposite the head, and knot inside.

6. Bigger Shelby (~5.7 cm across)

Work the shell to 42 stitches: R1 6, R2 12, R3 18, R4 24, R5 [3 sc,inc] x6 (30), R6 [4 sc,inc] x6 (36), R7 [5 sc,inc] x6 (42), R8 BLO (42), R9 sc around (42). Underside R1-R7 the same to 42, do not fasten off. Rnd 8: 7 sc, (sc,hdc,hdc,sc) in next, 8 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 7 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 8 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 7 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next = 53, consuming 42 anchors. Join 42 to 42 by the same rule. Allow 45-50 minutes and ~4 g.

Troubleshooting

- **Flippers uneven.** Count the plain runs between bumps: 3, 4, 3, 4, 3, then 2 at the end.
- **Keyring pulls out / too fat to hang.** Attach through two stitches and knot inside. Use less stuffing so the charm stays flat against a bag.
- **Shell and base won't pair.** Count anchor positions (19 plain + 5 bumps = 24), not the 35 outer stitches.

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Safety reminder

Shelby uses 4 mm safety eyes (French knots recommended at this size) and a metal keyring. Sold as a keyring/bag charm; not tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71. For children under 3 use French knots, attach the ring through two stitches and knot inside.

Happy crocheting!

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